

Commodity Shock & Inflation

Real public data - the 2022 energy/food price shock and inflation.

2022 INFLATION (5-ECONOMY AVG)	EURO NATURAL GAS PEAK	BRENT CRUDE PEAK	INVASION DATE
6.1%	+151%	+38%	24 Feb 2022
Up from low single digits pre-2021 (US 8.0%, UK 7.9%, JP 2.5%).	Aug 2022 vs Jan 2022 - the sharpest move of the three commodities.	Jun 2022 vs Jan 2022; wheat peaked +36% in May 2022.	Reference event for the timeline; not asserted as sole cause.

Energy and food commodity prices and consumer inflation both surged in 2022, coinciding with the 24 Feb 2022 invasion of Ukraine - a region central to global energy and grain exports.

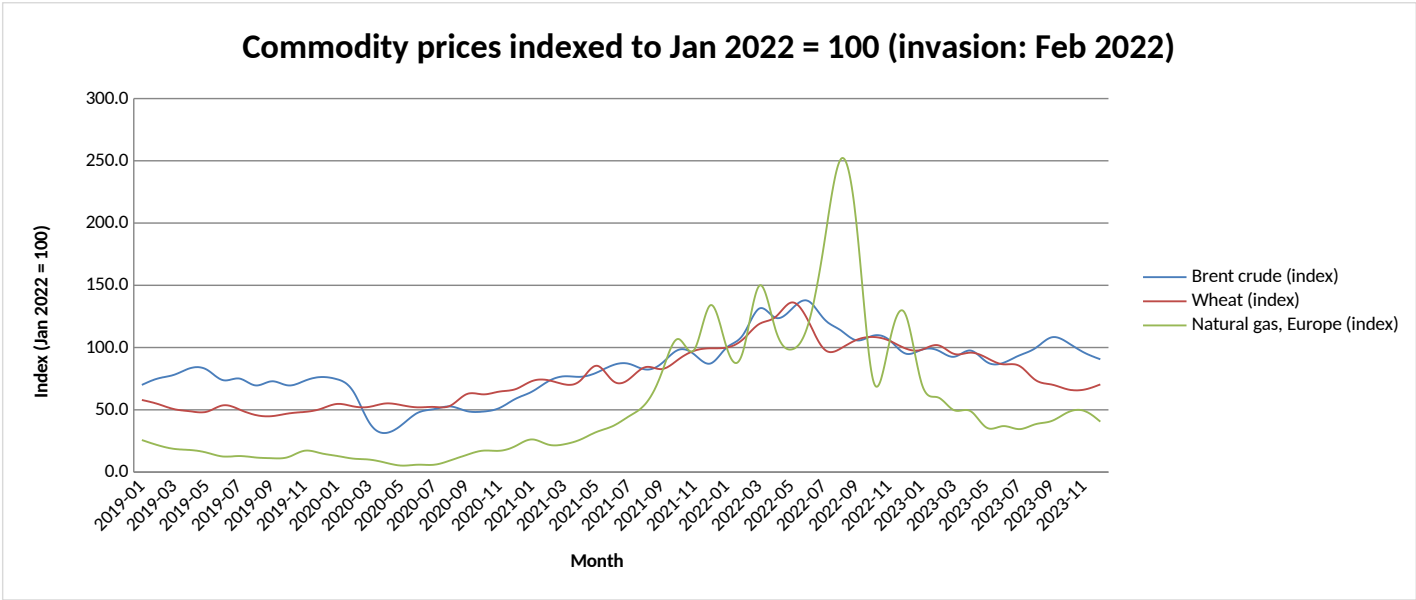
Caveat: this is a timeline and co-movement, not a sole-cause claim. Post-pandemic demand, supply chains, and monetary policy also drove inflation; Japan's muted 2.5% shows the shock was broad but uneven.

Source: FRED (commodity prices, monthly) and World Bank (consumer inflation, annual). Vendored snapshot - see data/SOURCES.md.

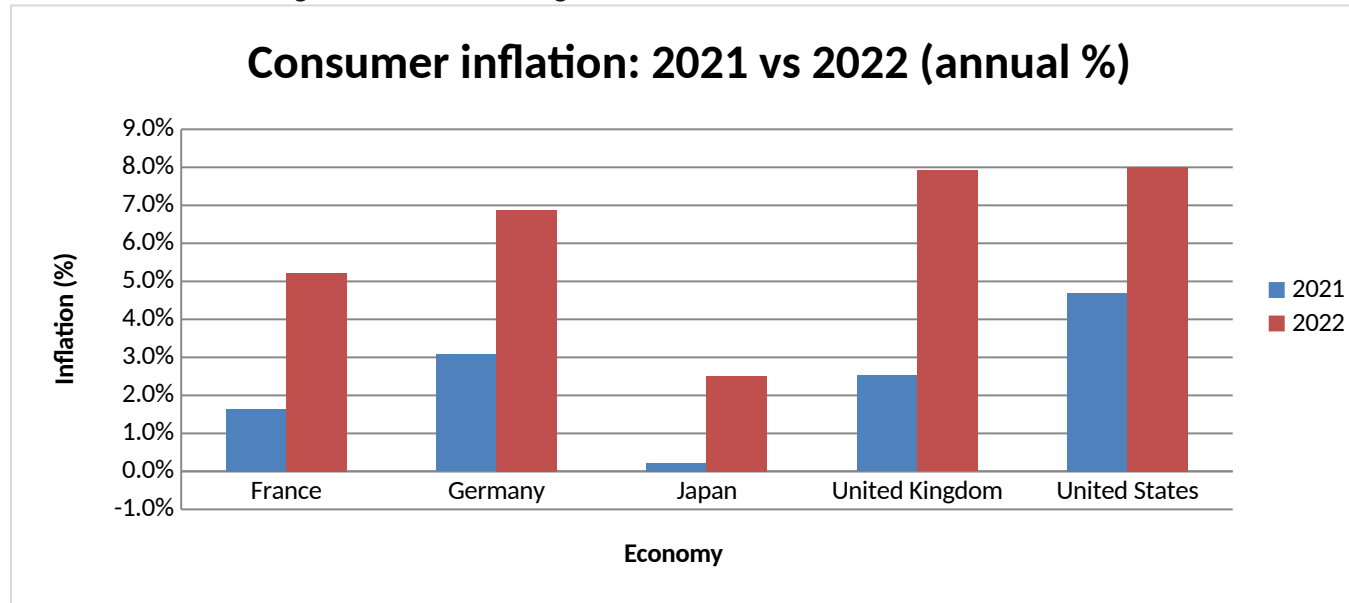
Commodity Shock

Brent crude, wheat, and European natural gas, indexed to Jan 2022 = 100.

Commodity	Jan 2022	Peak	Peak month	Peak vs Jan 2022	Latest (Dec 2023)
Brent crude (USD/bbl)	\$85.62	\$117.69	2022-06	+38%	\$77.54
Wheat (USD/mt)	\$326	\$444	2022-05	+36%	\$230
Natural gas, Europe (USD/MMBtu)	\$27.89	\$69.98	2022-08	+151%	\$11.30



Inflation by Economy



Economy	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023
France	1.1%	0.5%	1.6%	5.2%	4.9%
Germany	1.5%	0.1%	3.1%	6.9%	6.0%
Japan	0.5%	0.0%	-0.2%	2.5%	3.3%
United Kingdom	1.7%	1.0%	2.5%	7.9%	6.8%
United States	1.8%	1.2%	4.7%	8.0%	4.1%

Monthly Backing Data

Full commodity price series (USD), as fetched - the raw evidence.

Month	Brent (USD/bbl)	Wheat (USD/mt)	Nat gas EU (USD/MMBtu)
2019-01	\$59.94	\$189	\$7.16
2019-02	\$64.38	\$178	\$5.99
2019-03	\$66.94	\$165	\$5.20
2019-04	\$71.48	\$159	\$4.95
2019-05	\$70.39	\$158	\$4.36
2019-06	\$63.21	\$175	\$3.48
2019-07	\$64.32	\$164	\$3.60
2019-08	\$59.62	\$149	\$3.27
2019-09	\$62.43	\$147	\$3.09
2019-10	\$59.63	\$153	\$3.34
2019-11	\$62.69	\$158	\$4.78
2019-12	\$65.35	\$165	\$4.24
2020-01	\$63.90	\$178	\$3.63
2020-02	\$55.69	\$172	\$3.00
2020-03	\$33.95	\$171	\$2.79
2020-04	\$26.85	\$180	\$2.08
2020-05	\$32.42	\$175	\$1.46
2020-06	\$40.86	\$170	\$1.65
2020-07	\$43.30	\$171	\$1.64
2020-08	\$45.08	\$174	\$2.61
2020-09	\$41.93	\$204	\$3.85
2020-10	\$41.61	\$203	\$4.81
2020-11	\$44.05	\$211	\$4.78
2020-12	\$50.38	\$217	\$5.83
2021-01	\$55.22	\$238	\$7.30
2021-02	\$62.36	\$241	\$6.17
2021-03	\$65.80	\$230	\$6.21
2021-04	\$65.53	\$240	\$7.28
2021-05	\$68.38	\$278	\$9.00
2021-06	\$73.51	\$239	\$10.32
2021-07	\$74.40	\$244	\$12.52
2021-08	\$70.59	\$275	\$15.28
2021-09	\$74.75	\$270	\$22.23
2021-10	\$83.87	\$294	\$29.81
2021-11	\$80.89	\$317	\$27.38
2021-12	\$74.68	\$324	\$37.36
2022-01	\$85.62	\$326	\$27.89
2022-02	\$94.27	\$348	\$26.98
2022-03	\$112.44	\$388	\$41.73
2022-04	\$106.16	\$406	\$31.99
2022-05	\$112.11	\$444	\$27.46
2022-06	\$117.69	\$398	\$32.91
2022-07	\$105.25	\$322	\$51.15
2022-08	\$97.64	\$323	\$69.98
2022-09	\$90.61	\$346	\$55.18
2022-10	\$93.72	\$354	\$20.81
2022-11	\$90.94	\$344	\$28.79
2022-12	\$81.50	\$324	\$35.37
2023-01	\$84.08	\$320	\$19.89
2023-02	\$83.63	\$332	\$16.74
2023-03	\$79.26	\$309	\$13.87
2023-04	\$83.54	\$313	\$13.68
2023-05	\$75.75	\$299	\$9.97
2023-06	\$74.97	\$282	\$10.29
2023-07	\$80.11	\$279	\$9.61
2023-08	\$85.17	\$241	\$10.72
2023-09	\$92.67	\$229	\$11.43
2023-10	\$88.95	\$216	\$13.39
2023-11	\$82.19	\$216	\$13.71
2023-12	\$77.54	\$230	\$11.30

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